

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

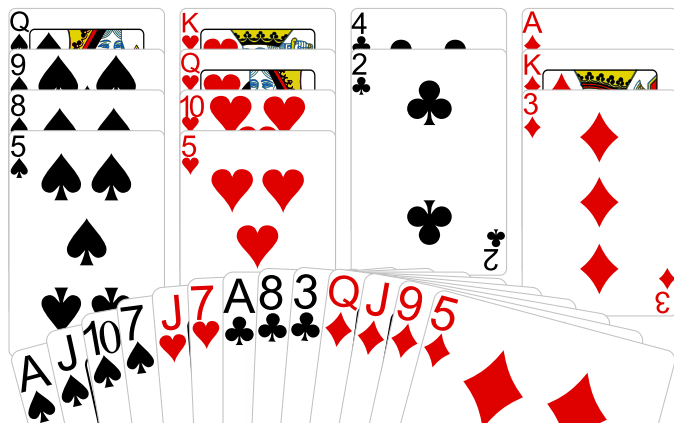
Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



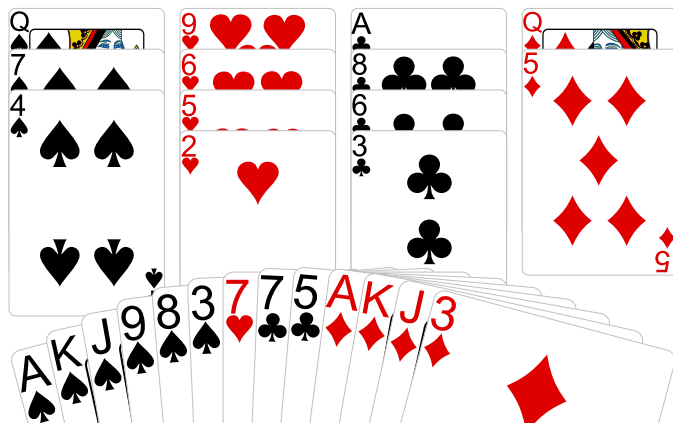
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



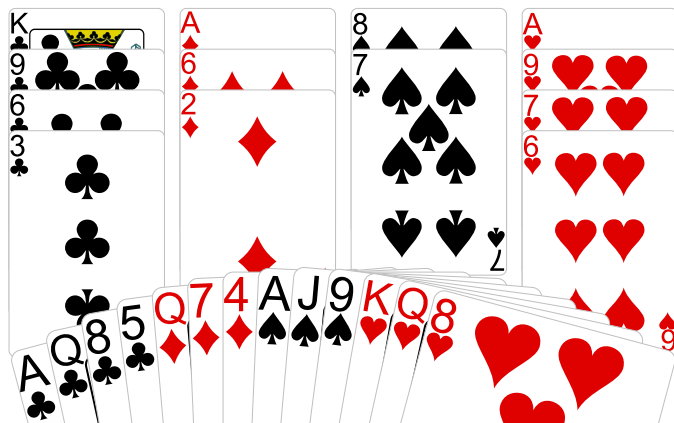
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 4 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 2
 ♥ A 8 4 2
 ♦ T 7 4
 ♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A J T 7

♥ J 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 4 3

♥ 9 6 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K Q T 6

♠ Q 9 8 5

♥ K Q T 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 4 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits SOUTH makes a Takeout Double.

NORTH has 13 points so she bids 2 ♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising SOUTH of NORTH's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

SOUTH suggests ♥s as trumps. NORTH doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. SOUTH agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4 ♠.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 4
♥ 9 6 5 2
♦ Q 5
♣ A 8 6 3

♠ 5 2

♥ A J T 8

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ Q J 4



♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5

♠ T 6

♥ K Q 4 3

♦ T 7 6

♣ K T 9 2

SOUTH's 1♥ opening is passed around to EAST. He is tempted to overcall 1♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points WEST is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2♣.

EAST now bids 2♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

WEST raises to 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	Pass	Dbl	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 3

♣ J 7 4

♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 7 6

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 9 6 3



♠ T 6 5 3

♥ J T 4

♦ K T 9 5

♣ T 2

♠ A J 9

♥ K Q 8

♦ Q 7 4

♣ A Q 8 5

SOUTH has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

NORTH bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When SOUTH denies holding a 4-card Major NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since SOUTH promised he had the suit controlled.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 6
♥ K Q J
♦ A J 9 7
♣ K Q 4

♠ K Q 3

♥ A T 8

♦ T 5 4 3

♣ 9 5 3



♠ J T 5 2

♥ 7 6 4 2

♦ 8 6

♣ J 8 6

♠ 9 7 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ K Q 2

♣ A T 7 2

WEST has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

EAST has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming WEST wants to hear his best suit.

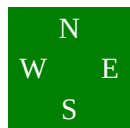
WEST now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. EAST passes, of course.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Dbl	Pass	1♠	Pass
1NT			
All Pass			
1NT by West			

Board 5
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 8 5
♥ 9 7 3 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 5 3 2

♠ Q 7 4
♥ A Q T
♦ K J 7 5
♣ A K 6



♠ T 9 3
♥ K J 8 4
♦ T 4 2
♣ Q J T

♠ K J 6 2
♥ 6 5
♦ A Q 3
♣ 9 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Dbl	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

NORTH has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

SOUTH has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2 ♠.

In theory NORTH could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.